

PPC Negative Keyword Starter List

600+ Terms by Industry

Most new Google Ads accounts waste 20-40% of budget on irrelevant queries in the first month. Load these negatives before you launch.

What's inside

- 600+ terms across 9 industries
- Universal job-seeker and DIY negatives
- Match type guidance for negatives
- Search term review cadence
- Account vs campaign level structure

Universal Negatives

- 01 Employment: jobs, salary, career, hiring, internship
- 02 Free intent: free, freeware, no cost, gratis
- 03 Learning intent: how to, tutorial, DIY, course
- 04 Low value: cheap, used, second hand, torrent

Structure

- 01 Apply universal negatives at account level
- 02 Campaign-level lists for service-line separation
- 03 Ad group negatives to control internal overlap
- 04 Use phrase match negatives for multi-word concepts

Ongoing Hygiene

- 01 Review the search terms report weekly in month one
- 02 Move to fortnightly once spend stabilises
- 03 Add negatives before pausing keywords
- 04 Watch for close variants matching unintended intent

Cautions

- 01 Over-negating starves campaigns of learning data
- 02 Check negatives are not blocking your own brand terms
- 03 Broad match negatives can block more than expected
- 04 Document why each negative was added

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